

PAVAN KUMAR NAYAKANTI

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Platform Modernization & Multi-Team Engineering Leader with 20+ years delivering enterprise-scale reliability for Fortune-level clients -- scaled engineering organizations from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US, driven CI/CD maturity and IaC governance on Azure, and built observability-first cultures with SLO/error-budget practices at ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO.

Core Competencies

Multi-Team Engineering Leadership

Platform Modernization & Strangler-Fig Migration

CI/CD Maturity & Azure DevOps

IaC Governance (Terraform / Bicep)

SLO / Error Budget & Reliability Engineering

Incident Response & Blameless Postmortems

Workforce Planning & Hiring Strategy

Executive Communication & Global Stakeholders

Technical Skills

Cloud & Platform

Azure (AZ-305), AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, AWS CDK, Ansible

CI/CD & DevOps

Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, UrbanCode, GitLab

Observability

Dynatrace, Prometheus, Grafana, Splunk, MS AppInsights, OpenTelemetry, Telegraf

Reliability Engineering

SLI/SLO, Error Budgets, Chaos Engineering (Keptn), Self-Healing, DORA Metrics

ITSM & Incident Mgmt

ITIL, ServiceNow, Incident/Problem/Change Management

Automation & Scripting

Python, Ansible, Bash, PowerShell, Groovy, C#.Net

AI / GenAI

Azure AI (AI-102), AIOps, MLOps, GenAI Solutions (Azure & AWS)

Education

- **Masters in Artificial Intelligence** 2024
Woolf University
- **General Management Program** 2022
ISB Hyderabad
- **M.Sc Computer Science** 2002
Osmania University

Work Experience

IRIS Software

Sep 2020 -- Present

Sr. Specialist -- Cloud Practice & SRE Lead | Multi-Team Engineering Leader

Hyderabad, India | Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO

- ⊕ Scaled ADP's engineering organization from **4 to 40 engineers and architects** across India, Canada, and the US -- defining org structure, engineering standards, on-call rotation, and hiring strategy for a multi-team SRE practice.
- ⊕ Built Charles Schwab's **18-member Platform Engineering team from the ground up** -- establishing foundational SRE practices, reliability reviews, and incident governance; delivered 99.9% release reliability.
- ⊕ Delivered **modeas**, a high-throughput CI/CD platform handling **200+ builds/deployments per hour** -- eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and improving deployment cadence by 600%.
- ⊕ Led on-premises to AWS cloud **platform modernization for BMO** -- CDK-enabled deployment pipelines for .NET workloads across ECS Fargate and Lambda with HA/DR from day one; zero production outages during cutover.
- ⊕ Drove **CI/CD maturity and IaC governance** via Terraform-driven infrastructure-as-code and self-healing system implementations -- improving release velocity and operational resilience to 99.9%.
- ⊕ Defined and governed **SLOs, SLIs, and error budgets** across multi-client cloud platforms, establishing reliability thresholds aligned to business commitments for ADP, BMO, and Charles Schwab.
- ⊕ Instituted **blameless postmortem culture and automated remediation** workflows (Ansible + Python) -- reducing MTTR by 40%+ and embedding structured RCA across the engineering organization.
- ⊕ Delivered **executive-ready reporting** -- quarterly presentations on reliability strategies, SRE metrics, and architectural outcomes to VP and C-suite stakeholders at three Fortune-level financial institutions.
- ⊕ Established **Chaos Engineering practices** using Keptn -- proactively identifying fault scenarios and hardening platform reliability under real-world failure conditions.

◆ Certifications

- ⊕ Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) -- 2026
- ⊕ Certified SRE (iSRE)
- ⊕ Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) -- 2025
- ⊕ Azure AI Solution Design (AI-102) -- 2025
- ⊕ AWS Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C01)
- ⊕ ITIL Certificate in IT Service Operations
- ⊕ PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

IRIS Software

Jun 2018 -- Sep 2020

Automation Technology Specialist -- DevSecOps & Platform Engineering

Toronto, Canada | Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance

- ⊕ Designed the **Robo Deployment Framework** -- PowerShell-native CI/CD orchestration enabling self-service release pipelines across 250+ applications; reduced application onboarding from **5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction)**.
- ⊕ Inducted and operationalized the **DORA framework** across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance -- establishing Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary engineering health metrics.
- ⊕ Governed enterprise-wide DevOps and change management across **250+ applications across 60+ teams** -- standardizing deployment workflows, enforcing SOX/GDPR compliance, and ensuring audit-ready change transparency.
- ⊕ Led enterprise migration from CA SCM/Harvest to **GitHub Enterprise**, enabling modern CI/CD and self-service provisioning at scale for 60+ engineering teams.
- ⊕ Established SRE principles within RBC's DevSecOps programme -- introducing observability standards, incident classification frameworks, and reliability-focused deployment gates.

IRIS Software

Feb 2017 -- Jun 2018

Automation Architect -- Capital Markets & Insurance

Toronto, Canada

- ⊕ Designed **fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines** using Kubernetes and Helm -- enabling zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms.
- ⊕ Led RPA practice delivery -- automating 80+ applications and 250+ components across heterogeneous stacks (Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, Mainframe).

TechMahindra

Jul 2015 -- Feb 2017

Technology Manager -- Enterprise Application Modernization

Noida, India | Client: Adobe

- ⊕ Architected and delivered **zero-downtime business application migration** during Adobe's data centre relocation -- owned full plan, execution, and cutover across all production workloads.
- ⊕ Led SAP HANA upgrades and enterprise application modernization with minimal service disruption across cross-functional global teams.

Microsoft Corporation

Jul 2007 -- Dec 2014

Sr. SDET -- Production Engineering & Platform Reliability

Hyderabad, India | Sales & Marketing Platforms (US, EMEA, APAC)

- ⊕ Held dual mandate as Sr. SDET and Production Engineering owner -- accountable for quality and operational lifecycle of enterprise Sales & Marketing platforms serving tens of thousands of users across US, EMEA, and APAC.
- ⊕ Achieved **sustained 99.99% uptime over a 7-year tenure** -- owned all non-functional objectives (performance, availability, scalability, security) and structured incident response.
- ⊕ Built and led QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD pipelines -- eliminating manual testing bottlenecks and accelerating release confidence across global engineering teams.
- ⊕ Modernized marketing platforms through cloud migration and **self-healing architectures**, supporting 200% user growth with no degradation in platform reliability.

Key Delivery Highlights

modeas -- High-Throughput CI/CD Platform

Platform Modernization

Architected and delivered an enterprise deployment platform handling 200+ builds/deployments per hour. Eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually. Improved deployment cadence by 600%. Built on Azure/AWS with Terraform-governed IaC and self-healing pipelines.

Robo Deployment Framework (RBC)

CI/CD & IaC Governance

Designed a PowerShell-native CI/CD orchestration platform for 250+ applications across 60+ teams under SOX/GDPR constraints. Reduced application onboarding time from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction). Automated artifact retrieval and approval workflows with compliant change evidence pipelines.

ADP SRE Organization Scale-Up

Engineering Leadership

Built ADP's SRE organization from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US. Defined org structure, engineering standards, blameless postmortem culture, and on-call governance. Deployed Keptn-based Chaos Engineering and Dynatrace observability -- reducing MTTR by 40%+.